Date: 2/2/2026 5:25:00 PM
From: "Ishii, Adena" AIshii@berkeleyca.gov
Cc: "Dupaya, Maricar C." MDupaya@berkeleyca.gov, "Lopez-Helm, Amelia" AHelm@berkeleyca.gov, "Rosete, Michelle" mrosete@berkeleyca.gov
Subject: Re: Request to all Charter Officers

Dear Charter Officers,

As a friendly reminder, our budget reductions are due this Thursday, February 5th. Please send your budget reduction workbooks (the spreadsheets the Budget Team shared) to Michelle and Maricar (cc'd here).

They will then review the numbers to ensure alignment with projected actuals. The Budget Team will present the council's budget reductions, and Director Aguilar, Auditor Wong, and City Attorney Brown (or their representatives) will present their own budget reductions to the Budget and Finance Committee in late March or early April. Thank you all for your hard work on this challenging topic.

Sincerely,

Mayor Ishii

Adena Ishii (*she/her)*
Mayor
Office of Mayor Adena Ishii
City of Berkeley
2180 Milvia Street, 5th Floor
Berkeley, CA 94704
(510) 981-7100
aishii@berkeleyca.gov
on Huichin Ohlone Land

ADENA ISHII
MAYOR OF BERKELEY

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From: Ishii, Adena <AIshii@berkeleyca.gov>
Sent: Monday, January 26, 2026 8:04 PM
To: Ishii, Adena <AIshii@berkeleyca.gov>
Cc: Dupaya, Maricar C. <MDupaya@berkeleyca.gov>; Lopez-Helm, Amelia

<AHelm@berkeleyca.gov>; Rosete, Michelle <mrosete@berkeleyca.gov>
Subject: Re: Request to all Charter Officers

Dear Charter Officers,

I've heard from many of you that you'd like more clarity and instructions around this request. After our last Budget and Finance Committee meeting, I have some points of clarity and an additional request:

- **Deadline: February 5th**
  - This deadline was set to line up with the requests made to department heads so that the Budget and Finance Team can review the proposed reductions all at once.
- **Form:** Our Budget Director, Maricar Dupaya, will send out the form for your office with instructions
- **Assistance:** Maricar has offered her team to sit down with our offices one on one to go over our budget reduction plans. Please reach out to Maricar *and* Michelle Rosete (cc'd here) to make an appointment if you need support.
- **Amount: 10% and 12.5%**
  - Although the initial request was for a reduction of 10%, the city departments are now looking at 12.5% reductions as well. Given the sobering look at the FY27 $32.2m and FY28 $33.2m baseline budget deficits, it would be prudent for us to look at a 12.5% reduction as well.

Thank you all for your efforts to address our budget deficit!

Sincerely,

Mayor Ishii

Adena Ishii (*she/her)*
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From: Ishii, Adena <AIshii@berkeleyca.gov>
Sent: Wednesday, December 10, 2025 2:34 PM
Subject: Request to all Charter Officers

Dear Charter Officers,

I'm reaching out regarding the fiscal challenges our city faces in FY 2027 and FY 2028. The General Fund structural deficit is currently estimated at $28 million in FY 2027 and $29 million in FY 2028, amounts that may grow following baseline adjustments. To address this deficit, the City Manager has asked each department head to look at 10% reductions to their budgets.

I seek your collaboration and support, as we all must do our part to help balance and right-size the city budget. After discussions with the Budget and Finance Committee, **I am requesting that all Charter Officers also analyze their FY 2027 and FY 2028 budgets and prepare General Fund reduction plans equal to 10% of their budgets.**

Attached is a copy of the full budget instructions provided to departments for reference. Once the baseline budget is developed, the City will move into the budget balancing phase. Below are some key deliverables for this phase in January 2026 that I would like us to align with:

- Budget Office provides updated FY 2027 and FY 2028 surplus/deficit estimates based on updated baseline and General Fund revenue projections
- Departments must prepare General Fund reduction plans equal to 10% of their budgets, net of any revenue loss associated with impacted positions
- All departments submit revenue proposals and preliminary balancing strategies

Please let me know if you or your staff have any questions about these instructions. I thank you all for helping our city through this challenging time. It's going to be tough, ***and*** I know we can make it through if we work together!

In partnership,

Mayor Ishii

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